Essays

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Based on the seven common characteristics of organisms, explain why mammals and trees are living things. (10 marks)

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Content	Description	Mark
Nutrition	- Mammals carry out heterotrophic nutrition / feed on other living organisms. - Trees carry out autotrophic nutrition / make their own food by photosynthesis.	
Respiration	- Mammals break down food in their cells to release energy for body activities such as movement, growth and repair. - Trees break down food in their cells to release energy for growth and development.	
Excretion	- Mammals excrete metabolic wastes in exhaled gas, sweat and urine. - Some trees store metabolic wastes in leaves which are shed off.	
Movement	- Mammals move from place to place to search for food, to find mates and to escape from danger. - Trees move during growing: shoots grow towards light and roots grow towards water.	
Sensitivity	- Mammals have sensory organs and muscular systems to detect and respond to light, sound, chemicals and many other stimuli. - Trees can detect light and water, and grow towards them.	
Growth	- Both mammals and trees grow by increasing their body size and complexity.	
Reproduction	- In mammals, sperms and ova fuse to form zygotes which will develop into offspring. - In trees, the male gametes and female gametes fuse to form embryos in seeds, which will germinate to form new individuals.	(Max. 7)
Communication		(Max. 3)
		(10 marks)

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Skills assessed	Marks
Understanding basic concepts	7
Communication	3

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